

Declarer Sheet — Notrump

Bridge Habit Map

AUCTION

General

- ☐ Check vulnerability
- ☐ Use every bid to get info — partner + opps → HCP + shape
- ☐ Start from minimum length & min HCP promised — refine as bids land
- ☐ Bids not made are as important as bids made (e.g. passed → not 1 opener, no 6-card major)
- ☐ Remember conventions tend to show the bidder's shape / HCP
- ☐ By end of auction — summarise what you know about opps + partner

Lead prep (if you'll be on lead)

- ☐ Pick a tentative opening lead during the auction, not after
- ☐ Watch for lead-directing double opportunities on artificial bids

PLAN — DISCIPLINE & LEAD

Discipline

- ☐ Pause at least 10 seconds before playing from dummy
- ☐ Review the auction — what's bid, what's not

- ☐ Treat it as a play problem handed to you on paper
- ☐ Analyse the opening lead — length, honor, shortness?

PLAN — NOTRUMP

Count

- ☐ Count sure winners (off the top)
- ☐ Work out how many extra tricks needed

Source of extras

- ☐ Pick suit(s) to develop — Force, Length, or Position
- ☐ Prefer Force when you can afford to lose the lead

Hazards & control

- ☐ How many tricks can defenders cash when in?
- ☐ Identify the danger hand — who must you keep off lead?
- ☐ Plan hold-ups to sever defensive communication

Execution

- ☐ Plan entries between hands; unblock high cards
- ☐ Decide which suit to attack first
- ☐ Cash short-suit winners last if needed as entries